



THE MIDDLE EAST



The Middle East has always been a very productive area. Its age-old civilizations have exported farming techniques, beautiful crafts, and three major religions all around the world. The discovery of oil has made parts of the Middle East very rich and powerful. Huge oil refineries are a common sight in the region. But the oil will not last forever, and other industries are being developed to keep the money coming in when the oil has run out.



Turkish bazaar

In the Middle East, many people shop in markets and bazaars. This shopkeeper is hoping to sell some of his brassware at the Great Covered Bazaar in Istanbul, Turkey.

Refugee Crisis

War has forced large numbers of people in the Middle East to flee their homes in order to seek safety. Millions of people are living in refugee camps around the Middle East as temporary shelter from the danger of war.



Dressed for the heat

Parts of the Middle East reach temperatures in excess of 113°F (45°C) in the summer, so people wear loose-fitting clothing and cover their heads to protect themselves from the sun's rays.

White clothes reflect bright sunlight and help people keep cool.

Some Muslim women wear head scarves.

